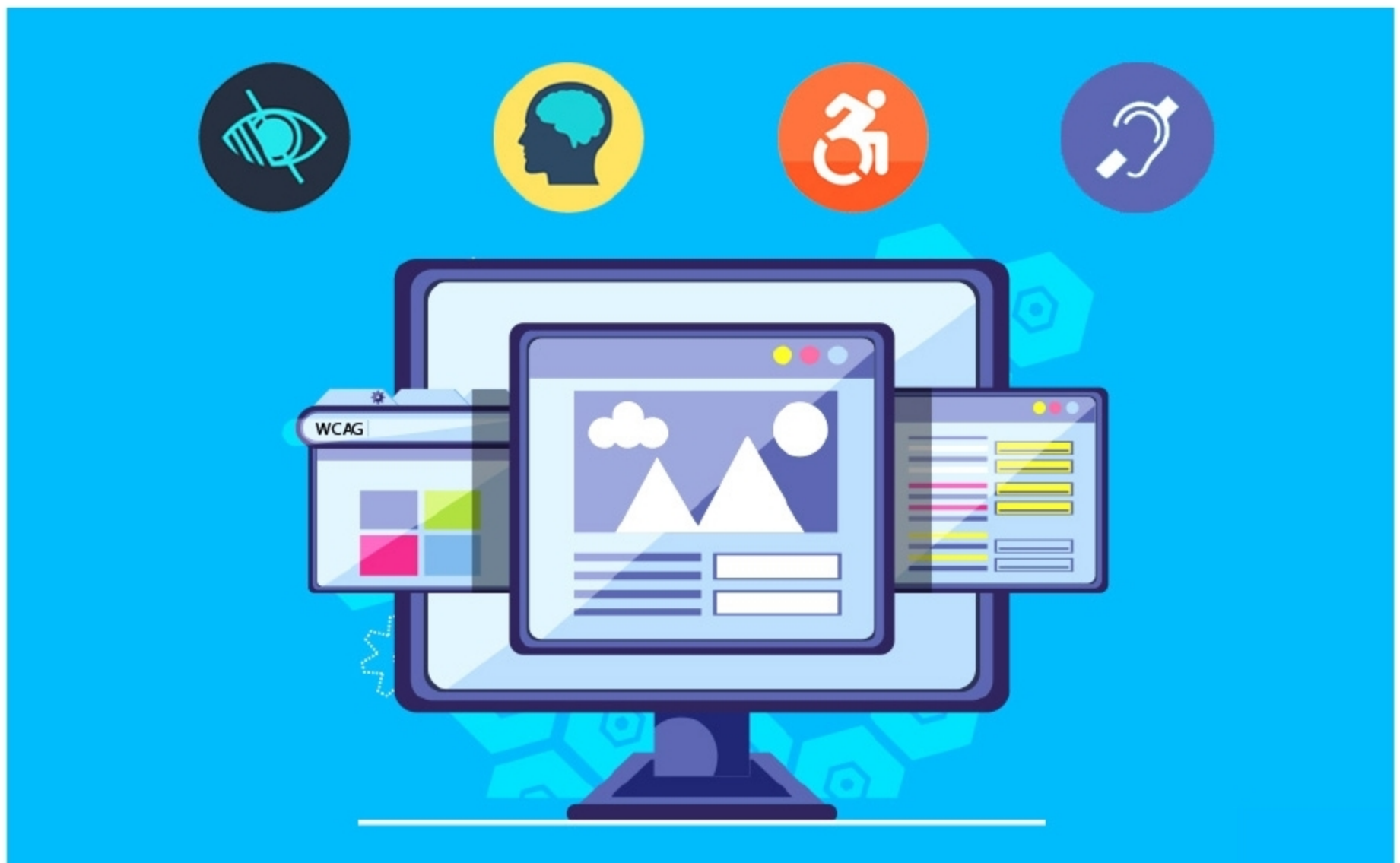


Is Your Website Accessible and Inclusive?

These days, organisations and governments prefer the Web as the priority channel for delivering services to customers and citizens, respectively. Hence, it becomes vital to design Web pages that can be accessed by everyone, irrespective of their physical disabilities. This article explores the importance of Web accessibility, as well as the tools and techniques needed to evaluate a site's accessibility status; it also provides suggestions on how to build accessible websites.



The World Wide Web is the largest information resource and is accessed by billions of users across the globe. The scale and spectrum of resources that the Web holds has made it very popular. These days, we use the Web not only to consume information but also to carry out a wide variety of tasks such as e-commerce, financial transactions,

pay bills and taxes, etc. Due to the ease of access, governments and organisations prefer the Web as a channel to deliver their services. However, if we ask ourselves the question, “Is the Web truly accessible to everyone?” the answer is unclear.

Web users come from a wide spectrum. There are certain groups of users with special needs such as those with disabilities and the elderly. When

developing a Web page, it is vital to keep the site accessible to everyone, irrespective of their age or disability. As Tim Berners Lee, the inventor of the World Wide Web, says, “The power of the Web is in its universality. Access by everyone regardless of disability is an essential aspect.”

The inventors of the World Wide Web had the vision that the resources provided by it should be accessed